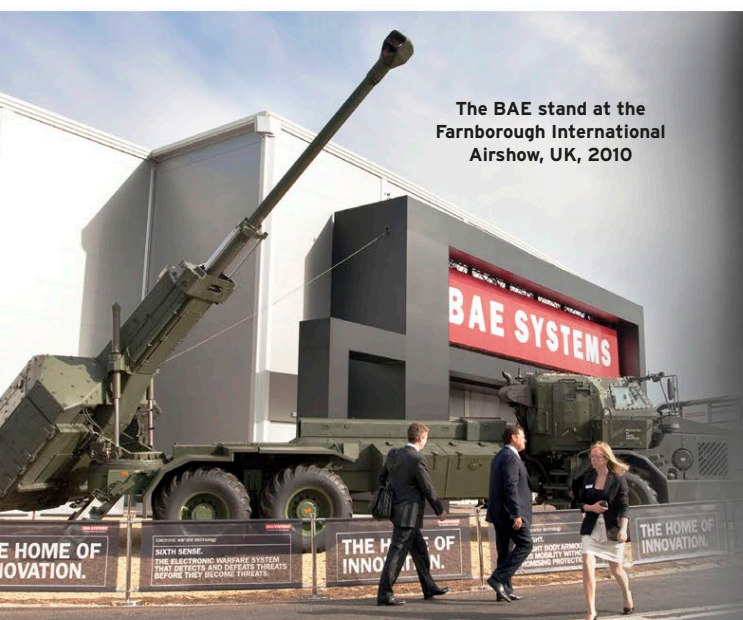




The BAE stand at the Farnborough International Airshow, UK, 2010

Key manufacturers BAE Systems

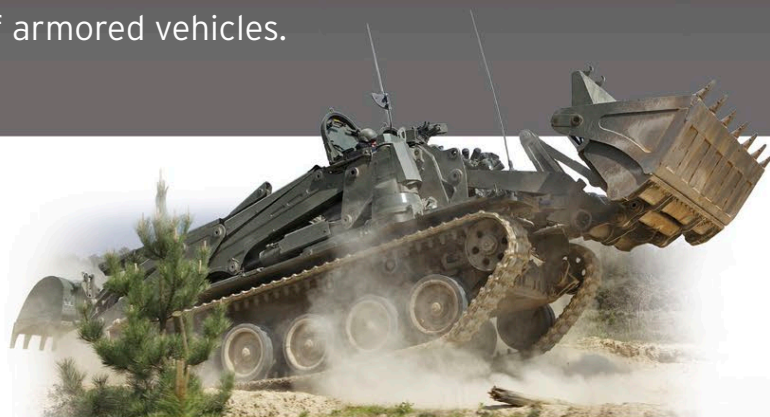
BAE Systems is one of the world's largest defense contractors. It produces virtually everything military, from aircraft carriers and nuclear submarines to rifles and ammunition. One of its core activities is the manufacture of armored vehicles.

BRITISH AEROSPACE, CREATED IN 1977, was a government-owned conglomerate of aircraft manufacturers whose component companies had a history stretching back to World War I. Denationalized in 1981, it soon began to expand, acquiring the Royal Ordnance Factories—producers of a wide variety of armaments and munitions, and every Main Battle Tank in service with the British Army since World War II—in 1987. Vehicle manufacturers The Rover Group was acquired in 1988, and finally, after radical restructuring, BA merged with Marconi Electronic Systems in 1999 to form BAE Systems. MES was itself a conglomerate, with naval shipyards as well as a first-rate electronics capability. However, other than ROF, BAE had no interest in military vehicle production. That shortcoming was soon rectified, however, for in 2004 it outbid General Dynamics for Alvis Vickers, by then the UK's most important armored vehicle builder.

Since 1919, Alvis had been a low-volume producer of automobiles. It became involved in building armored cars as early as 1937, and continued down that path after World War II, developing the six-wheeled FV600 series, which included the Saracen APC and Saladin armored car, adopted by the British Army in 1958. Briefly part of The Rover Group, and later British Leyland, the company changed hands again in 1981 to become part of United Scientific Holdings, which

manufactured gunsights. USH adopted the name Alvis in 1995. In 1997 it acquired Swedish competitor Hägglunds, and in the following year GKN Sankey, which was then supplying the British Army with its FV500-series tracked Infantry Fighting Vehicles (the Warrior and variants), which operated alongside Alvis' own lighter, aluminum-hulled FV100 family, the most successful member of which was FV101 Scorpion. In 2002, Alvis became Alvis Vickers on acquiring Vickers Defence Systems, which had a history of tank production stretching back to 1920, and was then producing Challenger 2, the British Army's Main Battle Tank.

Two years later, BAE acquired Alvis Vickers and merged it with ROF to create BAE Land Systems. In one stroke, BAE became the UK's only significant player, and soon strengthened its position in the US by acquiring United Defense Industries in 2005, and Armor Holdings two years later. UDI was an important supplier to the US military, boasting the M2/M3 Bradley Fighting Vehicles, M88 Hercules Armored Recovery Vehicle, and M109 Paladin self-propelled howitzer, as well as arguably the most widely-used Armored Personnel Carrier in the world, the M113. Armor, for its part, had taken over development of the Family of Medium Tactical Vehicles, based on a design by Steyr of Austria, just prior to its acquisition by BAE. The only fully protected member of the family was the Caiman MRAP (Mine-Resistant, Ambush-Protected) APC, which the US Army



Terrier armored digger

Weighing in at 33 tons (30 tonnes), the Terrier was much more capable than the British Army's previous Combat Engineer Tractor, and could be operated remotely if needed.

operated alongside the Marine Corps' Cougars, but others were installed with armored cabs. Land Systems Hägglunds AB was to produce the Combat Vehicle 90 (Stridsfordon 90) family of tracked IFVs. As well as the original 40mm Borfors cannon, versions armed with 30 and 35 mm Bushmaster chain



Bradley under construction

A Bradley Fighting Vehicle (BFV) turret awaits installation on the assembly line at the BAE Plc Land & Armaments facility in York, Pennsylvania, US.

